

TECHNOLOGY NEWS



openSUSE 11.1 eliminates the EULA

The openSUSE project has released version 11.1 of its operating system with significant enhancements to desktop productivity, entertainment applications, and software and systems management. The new version was entirely developed using



the recently released openSUSE Build Service 1.0, a collaboration system that enables contributors to work closely together on Linux packages or solution stacks. Updates to openSUSE 11.1 include: kernel 2.6.27.7, which adds support for a number of new devices and improved video camera support; remote desktop experience with Nomad; improvements to YaST that includes an improved partitioner, new printer module, and a new module to check system security; latest versions of major applications

including Firefox 3.0.4, OpenOffice.org 3.0, GNOME 2.24.1, KDE 4.1.3 and KDE 3.5.10 and Mono 2.0.1; further improvements to software management through improvements to the *zypper/libzypp* utilities; and much more.

Additionally, this release also brings in a simpler licence that eliminates the EULA and removes software that previously made it difficult to redistribute openSUSE. Version 11.1 can be freely downloaded now at www.opensuse.org.

3D graphics acceleration and bridged-networking with VirtualBox 2.1

Sun Microsystems has announced a new version of Sun xVM VirtualBox desktop virtualisation software. Sun claims that users of version 2.1 will benefit from significant improvements in graphics and network performance, easier configuration, hardware platform support for the latest processors and additional interoperability.

The new version boasts of accelerated 3D graphics, improved network performance that makes network intensive applications like rich media faster and finally introduces bridged networking configurations, and comes with built-in iSCSI support to connect to storage systems. In addition, xVM VirtualBox 2.1 software offers improved support for VMware's and Microsoft's virtualisation formats and enables support for the new Intel Core micro-architecture in the Intel Core i7 processor (codenamed Nehalem). It also allows users to run a powerful 64-bit guest OS on 32-bit host platforms without the need to upgrade the host OS, while taking advantage of multi-thread applications on powerful hardware. xVM VirtualBox software is available free of charge from the VirtualBox.org.



MySQL 5.1 simplifies management of large-scale database apps

Designed to improve performance and simplify the management of large-scale database applications, the production-ready MySQL 5.1 has been released. MySQL 5.1 features a number of new enterprise-class enhancements, including table and index partitioning, row-based and hybrid replication, an event scheduler, along with a new MySQL Query Analyser.

MySQL 5.1 is available now for a wide variety of hardware and software platforms, including Red Hat Enterprise Linux, SuSE Enterprise Linux Server, Microsoft Windows, Solaris 10 Operating System (OS), Macintosh OS X, FreeBSD, HP-UX, IBM AIX, IBM i5/OS and other popular Linux distributions. For downloads and more information on MySQL 5.1, go to dev.mysql.com/downloads.

BBC iPlayer comes to Linux

The British Broadcasting Corporation (BBC) and Adobe Systems have announced the public beta of the new BBC iPlayer Desktop download manager built on Adobe AIR. The new BBC iPlayer Desktop beta will enable Linux (and also Mac) users to download programmes to their desktops. Previously, the ability to download programmes was only available to Windows users. The new download manager allows users to view their favourite BBC shows, online or offline. The BBC iPlayer Desktop beta also integrates Adobe Flash Rights Management Server software for content protection.

The BBC iPlayer Desktop application on Adobe AIR will be available to BBC iPlayer Labs users, who can sign up at www.bbc.co.uk/iplayer/labs. It will be rolled out to all users during 2009.